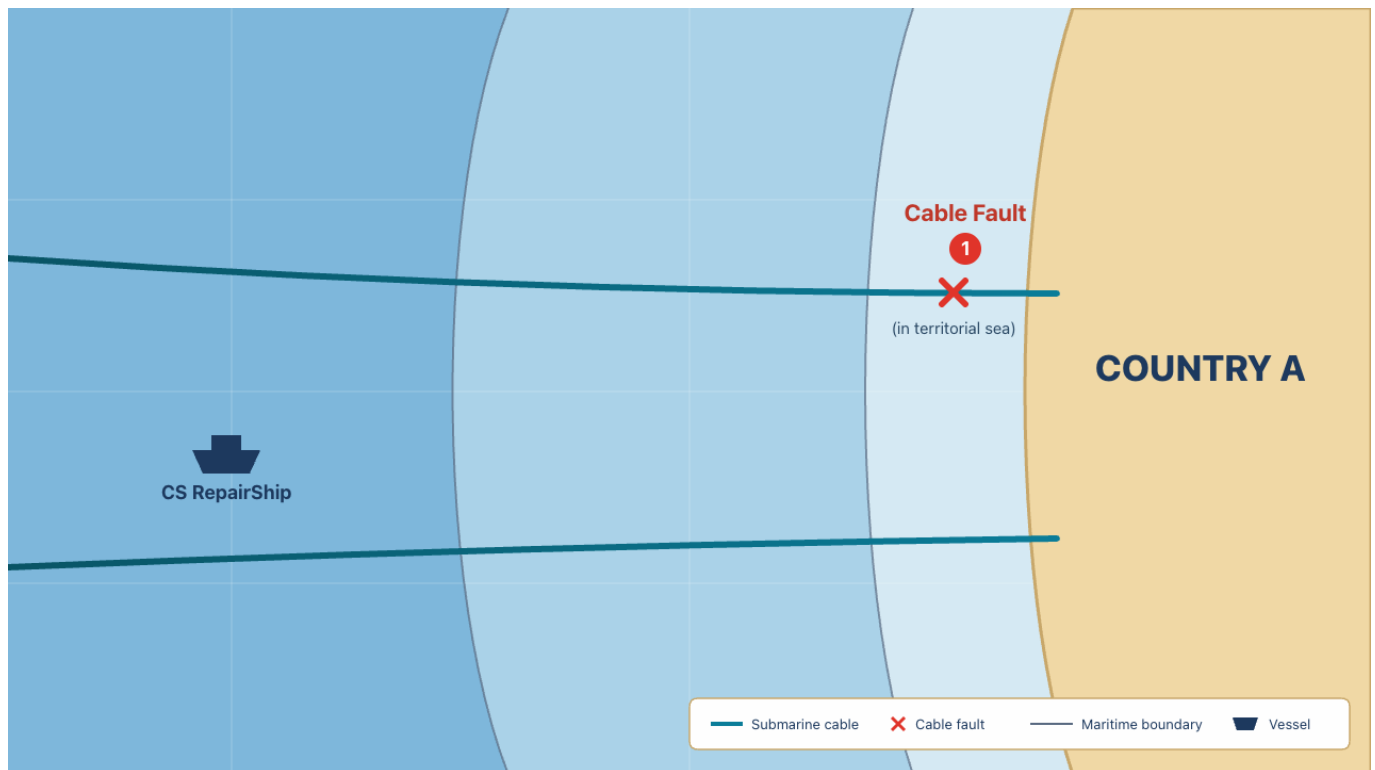


Scenario Exercise



Scenario 1

You are the members of **Country A National Cable Repair Coordination Forum**. The Forum is made up of **government regulators, cable owners, and repair operators** to facilitate cross-stakeholder coordination and harmonisation of regulations and procedures for cable repairs, including technical and logistical aspects, with the aim of addressing issues and providing solutions to support submarine cable maintenance and repair.

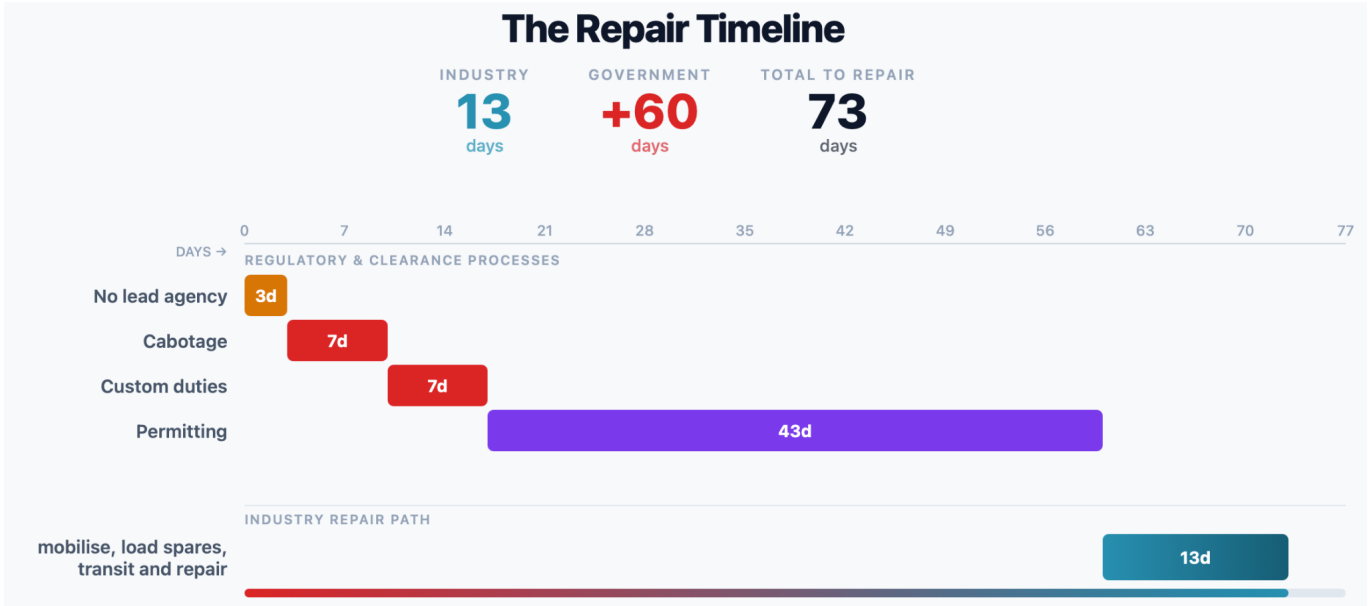
Country A's submarine cable has been **cut within its territorial sea** by a ship anchor. It's causing internet slowdowns for businesses and millions of everyday users.

The CS RepairShip can perform the repair. It is flagged to Country Z

Question 1: How would you make the processes (a) - (d) faster and more streamlined so the repair ship can start fixing the fault sooner?

The CS RepairShip can be ready to sail within 24 hours, but the repair ship operator has some regulatory processes to go through first and will not mobilise until they know they are able to get to the repair site, fearful of legal penalties or military interception.

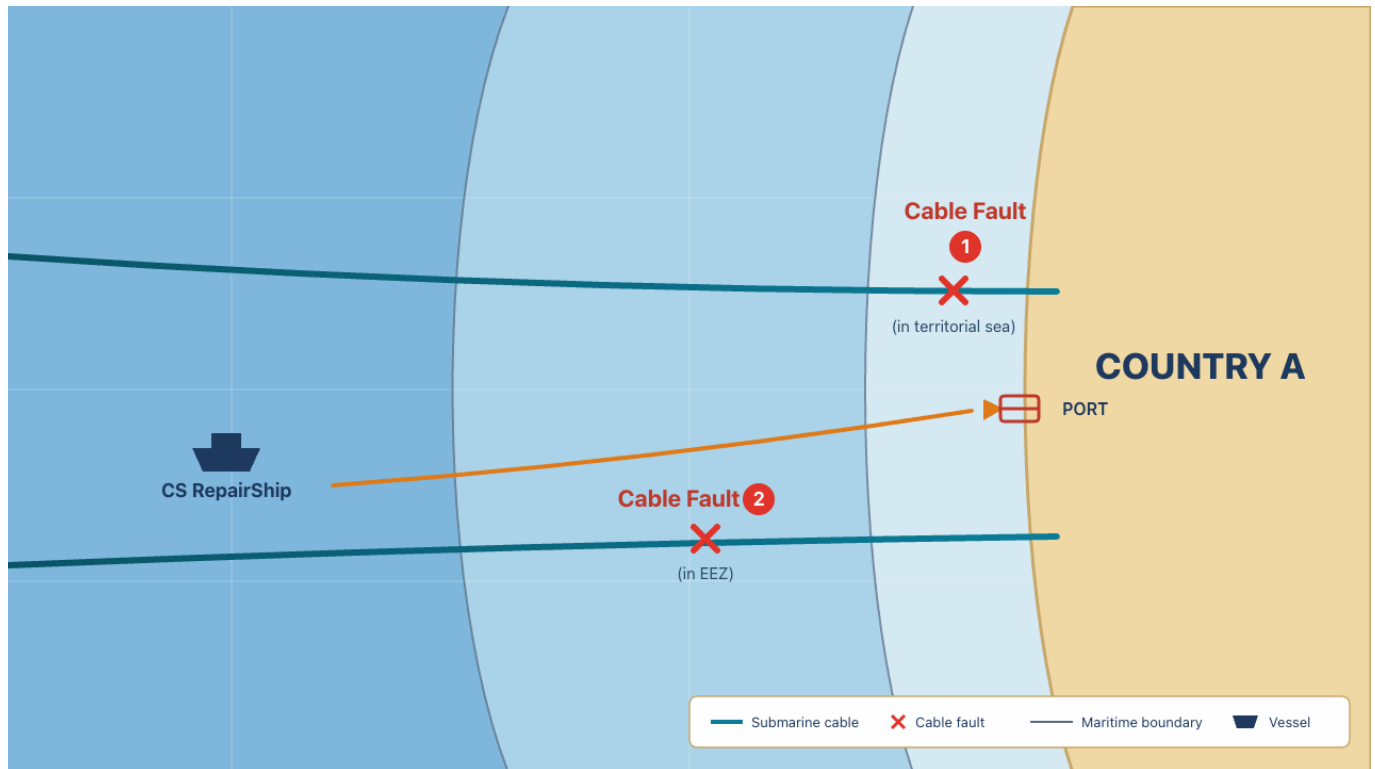
- a) **Agency ping-pong.** The operator tries to work out which government ministry is responsible for which permit. They get passed around through 4 ministries. It takes 3 days.
- b) **Foreign ship working in domestic waters.** Cable repair falls under Country A's cabotage laws. The ship is foreign-flagged. Country A's cabotage laws restrict foreign ships and crew from working in domestic waters. The repair operator tries to apply for a waiver. It takes 7 days to obtain.
- c) **Equipment import duties.** Country A treats the spare cables and repeaters as standard commercial imports. The spare cable and other repair components are going to be held at port while duties are assessed. There are disputes over the valuation. It takes 7 days to settle.
- d) **Long processing times.** Country A requires applications for environmental, spatial, maritime, and security permits. Some are required to be done sequentially, and they are managed by different departments. Together this takes 43 days.



Scenario 1 Repair Timeline for Country A

Scenario 1.5

⚠ **SECOND FAULT — Network outage**
Estimated impact: 200M per day



A fishing trawler has just cut through Country A's second submarine cable in Country A's EEZ. Both cables are now down. The internet is practically unusable. The estimated impact of an outage is 200M per day.

Question 2: Keep going with Question 1. Additionally...

- e) **Customs duties, taxes, and fees for EEZ transit, forced port entry.** Despite the fault being in the EEZ, Country A requires the vessel to make a detour and dock at port to clear immigration, pay port fees, and formally process the temporary importation of the subsea cable equipment spares. This adds 3 days in addition to the other processes in Question 1. Meanwhile the country continues to not have a usable internet.

Question 3: Reflecting on your own country's experience...

- a) Has your country adopted or tried to adopt any practices to streamline or expedite cable repairs?
- b) If so,
 - What were the key triggers that motivated change?
 - What challenges were faced and how were they overcome?
 - What challenges do you continue to face?